

Growth & Expansion

Sourcing, Scoping, and Handing Off Revenue Opportunity

Purpose

Define exactly what a CSM does alone versus what routes to Sales — so expansion revenue gets captured consistently instead of depending on individual initiative, and CSMs aren't put in negotiation situations they're not equipped for.

Growth Trigger Matrix

Signal	Response
Usage beyond current plan/seats	Flagged for expansion conversation
New stakeholder/department engaging	CS-led scoping call for expanded use case
Revenue crosses a tier threshold	Formal tier review — never a silent reassignment
Health score sustained 2+ quarters	Candidate for reference, case study, or upsell conversation
Client requests a new feature/integration	Routed to CS for a Product prioritization conversation, tracked for expansion potential

Retention vs. Expansion — Who Handles What, By Tier

Tier	Retention	Expansion
Tier 1	CSM, directly	CSM leads the conversation; Sales joins only for contract execution/pricing
Tier 2	CSM, directly	CSM sources and scopes; Sales negotiates anything beyond a small in-plan add-on
Tier 3	CSM, directly	CSM sources the signal from account knowledge; Sales closes anything contract-touching

The pattern: ownership gets less individual and more systemic the further down the tiers you go. Tier 1 is the CSM running the whole expansion motion; Tier 3 is the CSM sourcing the signal and handing execution to Sales.

Step-by-Step Process

- 1. Signal identification** Usage data, a new stakeholder appearing, or a direct customer request surfaces a growth trigger. CSM logs it the same day it's identified — not held until the next scheduled check-in.
- 2. Qualification** CSM assesses: is this a small in-plan add-on the customer can self-serve or the CSM can process directly, or does it require a new contract line? This decision determines the next step.
- 3. Handoff (where applicable)** Anything touching a contract — new pricing, a new product line, a material seat expansion — routes to Sales or Account Management. The CSM's role is to qualify and warm-hand the opportunity, not negotiate it. The CSM stays present through the handoff so the customer isn't re-explaining context to someone new.
- 4. Credit** The CSM is credited for sourcing the opportunity regardless of who closes it — this protects the incentive to surface expansion signals honestly rather than sitting on them.
- 5. Tier reassessment** Expansion that pushes an account's revenue above its current tier threshold triggers a formal review, same as the reverse case in contraction. The account's engagement model changes with its revenue, deliberately and visibly.

Artifacts

- Growth trigger matrix (above), embedded in the CS platform
- Expansion opportunity log (CSM-sourced, tracked to close)
- Handoff template (CS → Sales) capturing account context so nothing is re-explained
- Tier-reassessment review template